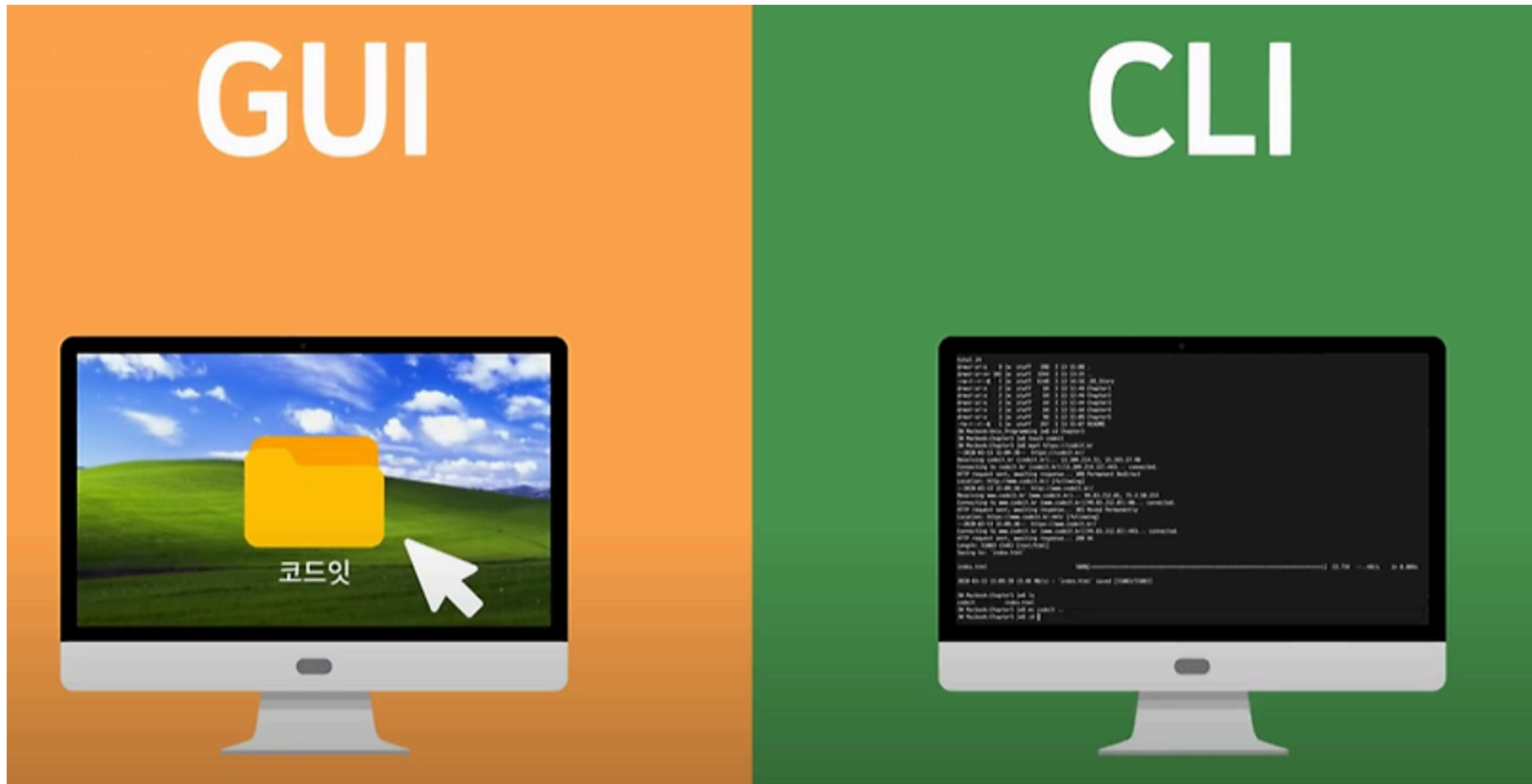


# File Navigation in Command Line Interface

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# Graphical User Interface vs. Command line interface



# Home Directory

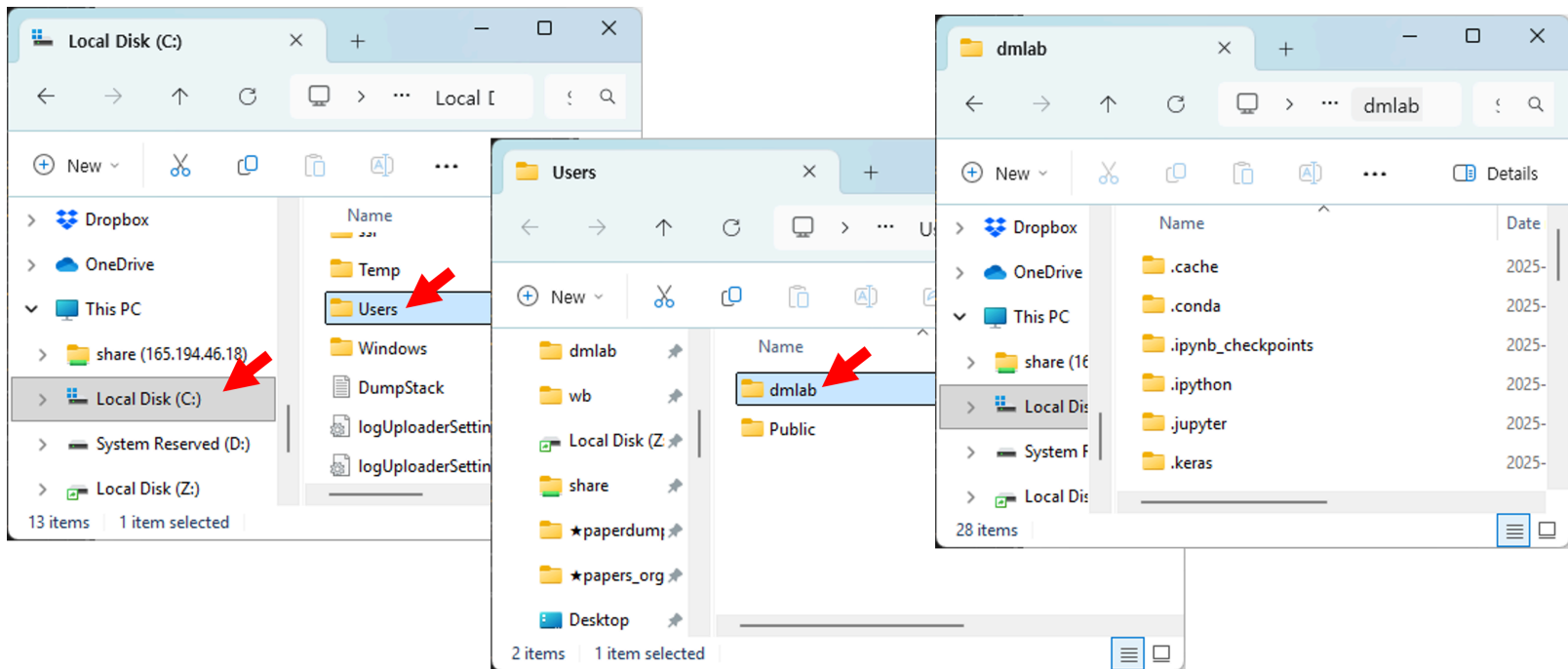
When you run Terminal or Command Prompt, it starts in your home directory.

- A home directory is a personal folder assigned to each user on a multi-user operating system, such as macOS and Windows.
- It's the default location for storing your personal files, including downloads, documents, photos, and music.

# Go to Home Directory Using File Manager

## Windows

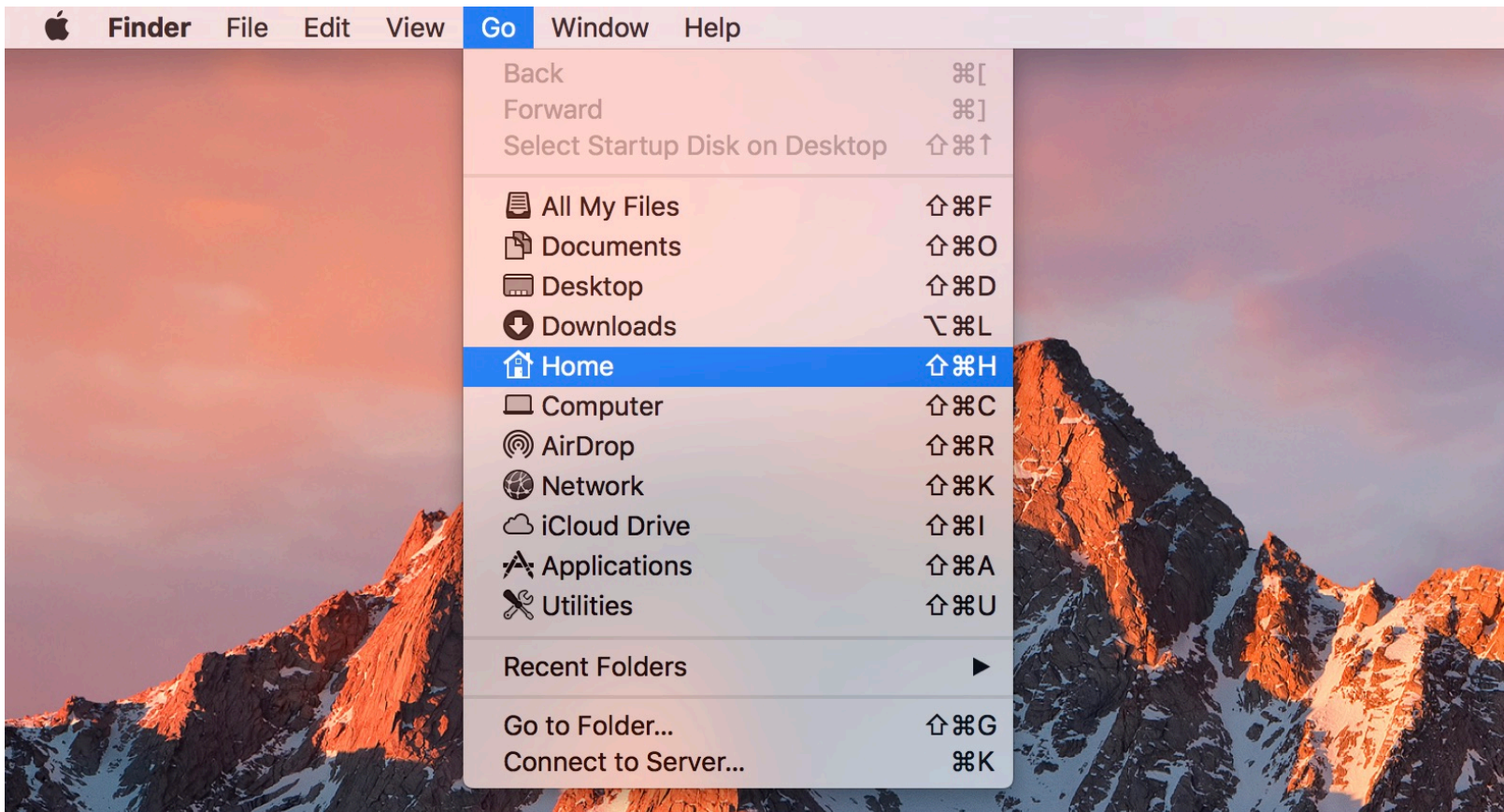
1. Open **File Explorer** and look for **This PC** on the navigation pane.
2. Click **c:** in the **This PC** and double click **Users** on the right-hand side
3. Select the folder named with your login username (e.g., **dmlab** in my case).



# macOS

Open Finder and choose any method you prefer.

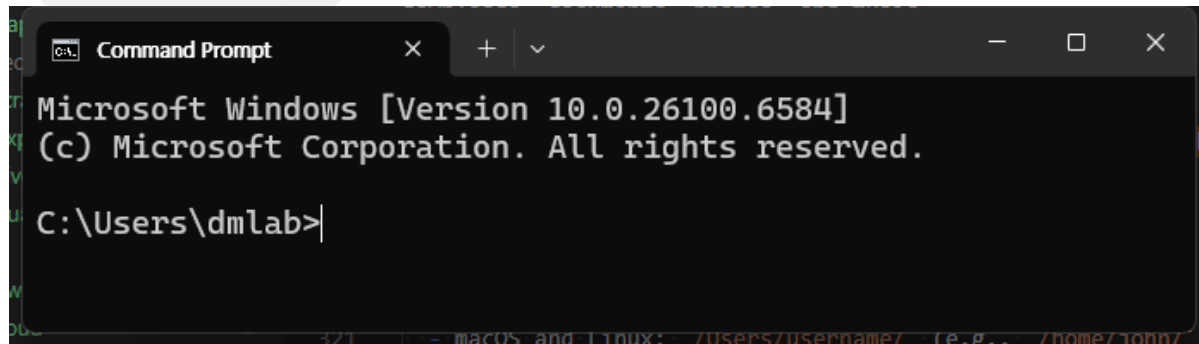
- **Method 1:** Use the keyboard shortcut `Command-Shift-H`.
- **Method 2:** Use the `Go` pull-down menu from the menu bar (see figure below).



# Run Command Line Interface

The application depends on your OS type.

- Windows: Command Prompt

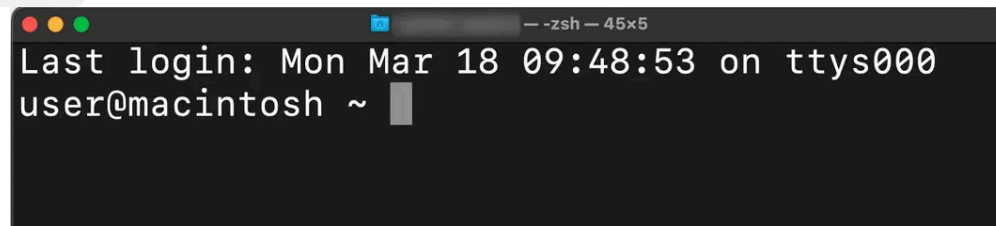
A screenshot of the Windows Command Prompt window. The title bar reads "Command Prompt". The text inside the window shows the Windows version and copyright information: "Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26100.6584] (c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved." followed by the current directory "C:\Users\dmlab>".

```
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26100.6584]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Users\dmlab>
```

⚠ Use Anaconda Prompt for Python-related tasks.

- macOS: Terminal

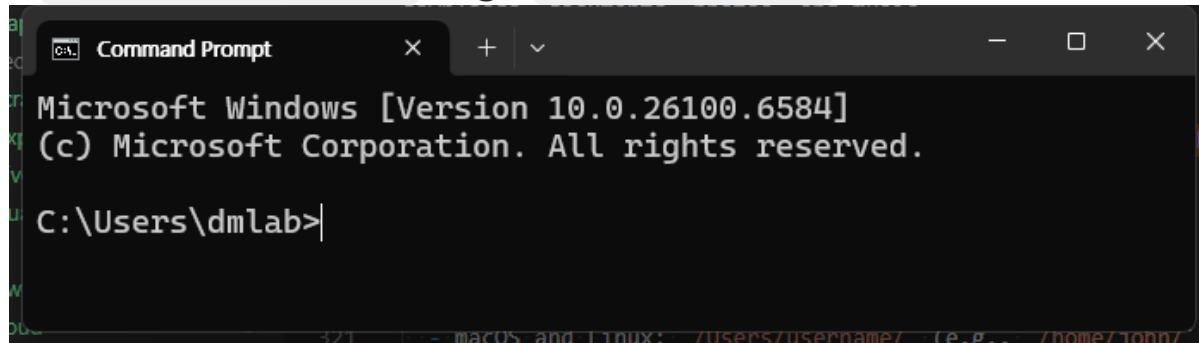
A screenshot of the macOS Terminal window. The title bar shows "zsh" and "45x5". The text inside the window shows the last login time and the user's prompt: "Last login: Mon Mar 18 09:48:53 on ttys000" followed by "user@macintosh ~" and a cursor.

```
Last login: Mon Mar 18 09:48:53 on ttys000
user@macintosh ~
```

# Go to Home Directory Using Prompt/Terminal

When you run Terminal or Command Prompt, it starts in your home directory.

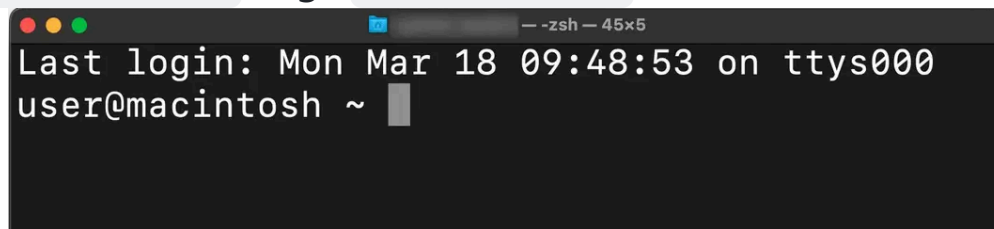
- Windows: `C:\Users\username\` (e.g., `C:\Users\dmlab` )



```
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26100.6584]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Users\dmlab>
```

- macOS: `/Users/username/` (e.g., `/Users/dmlab/` )



```
-- zsh -- 45x5
Last login: Mon Mar 18 09:48:53 on ttys000
user@macintosh ~
```



In macOS and Linux, `~` refers to the home directory.

## Navigating Directories in CLI

In GUI, navigating directories is a simple, visual process that's very intuitive. You can use a **file manager** application (e.g., File Explorer or Finder) that displays your files and folders as icons.

However, in CLI, you can navigate directories by typing commands like `cd`, which stands for **change directory**.

```
C:\Users\dm\lab> cd Downloads
C:\Users\dm\lab\Downloads> cd ..
C:\Users\dm\lab> cd ../../..
C:\> |
```



## Common Commands for All Operating Systems

- `cd` : change your current directory.
  - To move into a subdirectory named `Downloads` : `cd Downloads`
  - To go back to the parent directory: `cd ..`
  - To go to the parent folder two levels up: `cd ../..`

 **Tab Completion:** Pressing the `Tab` key while typing a directory name will auto-complete it, which helps prevent typos.

 (macOS only) To return to your home directory: `cd ~` or simply `cd` with no arguments.

- `ls` / `dir` : list the contents of the current directory.
  - macOS: `ls`
  - Windows: `dir`

Example: `cd` and `ls`

```
(base) christopher@cgl-slickbook:~$
```

1. Terminal started in the home directory.

2. `cd Desktop` : go to `Desktop` directory in the home directory.

 The user pressed `tab` after typing `cd De` for auto-completion.

3. `ls` : list all files in the current directory.

 Windows users must use `dir` command instead of `ls`.

4. `cd Hobbies` : go to the `Hobbies` directory in the current directory.

 The user pressed `tab` after typing `cd Ho` for auto-completion.

**Thank You.**